

Why Some Business Websites Get Customers While Others Don't

The Data Says It All

A practical website success report for business owners who want more enquiries, better trust, stronger visibility, and a website that actually supports sales.

Inside this report	Prepared by Websiteli
Research-backed statistics	websiteli.ch
Website success checklist	
Practical recommendations	Last updated: July 2026
Source list for every key number	

Executive summary

A successful website is not simply beautiful. It is clear, trustworthy, fast, mobile-friendly, searchable, accessible, and easy to act on.

The data shows that visitors make quick decisions, mobile speed affects abandonment, accessibility gaps remain widespread, checkout and forms create major friction, and AI is changing how people discover businesses online.

For small businesses, the most important question is not “Do we have a website?” but “Does our website help people understand, trust, and contact us?”

The most important numbers

10-20 sec Value proposition Users often leave web pages within 10-20 seconds unless the page communicates value quickly. Source: NNG	53% Mobile speed Over half of mobile visits are abandoned if a page takes more than 3 seconds to load. Source: GoogleSpeed
95.9% Accessibility gaps WebAIM found detectable WCAG 2 failures on 95.9% of the top one million home pages in 2026. Source: WebAIM	70.19% Cart abandonment Baymard tracks the average cart abandonment rate at 70.19%. Source: Baymard
89.77% Google share Google.com held 89.77% of worldwide search-engine-host market share in June 2026. Source: StatCounter	~30% AI search impact Nearly 30% of marketers reported decreased search traffic as consumers turn to AI tools. Source: HubSpot
92%+ SEO + AI SEO More than 92% of marketers plan on or already use SEO optimization for traditional and AI-powered search. Source: HubSpot	41.5% WordPress usage WordPress is used by 41.5% of all websites, according to W3Techs in July 2026. Source: W3Techs

How to use this report

Use the statistics as decision support, not decoration. Every number should lead to a practical improvement: clearer messaging, faster loading, better mobile design, stronger trust signals, cleaner forms, more useful content, or better accessibility.

A good website turns research into action. After each section, review the recommended changes and compare them with your own site.

1. Clarity beats decoration

A business website should answer three questions immediately: what you offer, who it is for, and what to do next. If visitors need to search for the meaning of your business, many will leave before your offer has a chance.

The practical lesson: write a specific headline, use plain service names, and make the primary call to action visible above the fold.

10-20 sec Value proposition Users often leave web pages within 10-20 seconds unless the page communicates value quickly. Source: NNG	10 sec Attention window To gain several minutes of attention, communicate the value proposition within about 10 seconds. Source: NNG
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2. Speed is a conversion issue

Performance is not only technical. Slow websites lose attention, reduce ad efficiency, and weaken trust. Speed should be treated as part of the customer journey.

The practical lesson: compress images, remove unnecessary scripts, use modern hosting, and test the mobile version after every major update.

53% Mobile speed Over half of mobile visits are abandoned if a page takes more than 3 seconds to load. Source: GoogleSpeed	>3 sec Abandonment point The three-second mobile load threshold is a critical risk point for visitor loss. Source: GoogleSpeed
22 sec Mobile average Google reported an average fully loaded mobile page time of 22 seconds in its mobile speed research. Source: GoogleSpeed	

3. Mobile-first is the default

Many customers first discover businesses from a phone, especially through search, social media, maps, and referrals. A desktop-only website can look acceptable to the owner and still fail for customers.

The practical lesson: design the mobile contact path first, make buttons easy to tap, and test every key page on a real phone.

6.12B Internet users DataReportal reported 6.12 billion people using the internet in April 2026. Source: DataReportal	~75% World online DataReportal reports that nearly three-quarters of the world population is online. Source: DataReportal
80.5% Adults online More than 4 in 5 adults aged 16+ use the internet globally. Source: DataReportal	5.79B Social identities There were 5.79 billion social media user identities worldwide at the start of April 2026. Source: DataReportalSocial

4. SEO is changing, but visibility still matters

Search is still one of the most important discovery channels, but AI answers and zero-click behavior mean websites need clearer, more structured, more useful content.

The practical lesson: build focused service pages, answer real customer questions, add FAQs, use descriptive titles, and keep business information consistent.

89.77% Google share Google.com held 89.77% of worldwide search-engine-host market share in June 2026. Source: StatCounter	~30% AI search impact Nearly 30% of marketers reported decreased search traffic as consumers turn to AI tools. Source: HubSpot
92%+ SEO + AI SEO More than 92% of marketers plan on or already use SEO optimization for traditional and AI-powered search. Source: HubSpot	27.2% Zero-click search Semrush reported that zero-click search accounted for roughly 27.2% of US search traffic in its 2025 State of Search data. Source: SemrushZero

5. Accessibility removes friction

Accessibility issues make websites harder to use for people with disabilities, older visitors, mobile users, and anyone trying to act quickly. Better accessibility often improves usability for everyone.

The practical lesson: use strong contrast, real text, labeled forms, keyboard-friendly navigation, meaningful links, and clear button labels.

95.9% Accessibility gaps WebAIM found detectable WCAG 2 failures on 95.9% of the top one million home pages in 2026. Source: WebAIM	56.1 Errors/page WebAIM detected an average of 56.1 accessibility errors per page across the top one million home pages. Source: WebAIM
1 in 26 Error exposure WebAIM estimates users with disabilities would encounter errors on 1 in every 26 home page elements. Source: WebAIM	

6. Forms and checkout need less friction

The final step is where many businesses lose leads. A visitor can be interested and still quit when the form is long, unclear, or feels risky.

The practical lesson: ask only for essential information, explain what happens next, and show a fallback contact method.

70.19% Cart abandonment Baymard tracks the average cart abandonment rate at 70.19%. Source: Baymard	134 Checkout guidelines Baymard references 134 checkout design guidelines in its checkout usability research. Source: Baymard
23.48 Checkout elements Baymard reports the average US checkout flow contains 23.48 form elements displayed by default. Source: Baymard	12-14 Ideal checkout Baymard says an ideal checkout flow can be as short as 12-14 form elements. Source: Baymard

7. Platforms do not replace strategy

It is easier than ever to launch a website, but the tool is not the strategy. A WordPress, Shopify, Wix, Webflow, or custom website can all fail if the message and conversion path are weak.

The practical lesson: decide the website goal before choosing features. Start with the audience, offer, proof, pages, and next step.

41.5% WordPress usage WordPress is used by 41.5% of all websites, according to W3Techs in July 2026. Source: W3Techs	59.2% CMS share WordPress represents 59.2% of websites whose CMS is known. Source: W3Techs
29.9% No tracked CMS W3Techs reports that 29.9% of websites use none of the CMS platforms it monitors. Source: W3CMS	5.2% Shopify usage Shopify is used by 5.2% of all websites in W3Techs CMS tracking. Source: W3CMS
4.3% Wix usage Wix is used by 4.3% of all websites in W3Techs CMS tracking. Source: W3CMS	1.2% Webflow CMS Webflow has a 1.2% CMS market share among known CMS websites. Source: W3CMS

Website success checklist

Use this checklist before publishing a new website, redesigning an old one, or reviewing why a website is not generating enough enquiries.

Area	What to check
Clarity	Can a visitor understand your offer in five seconds? Is the headline specific? Is the next step obvious?
Trust	Do you show contact details, proof, examples, reviews, security, and legal pages where needed?
Mobile	Are key pages easy to read, tap, navigate, and contact from a phone?
Speed	Are images compressed, scripts controlled, and pages tested on mobile?
SEO	Does each important service have a focused page with useful content and metadata?
AI visibility	Do FAQs and service pages answer customer questions clearly enough for AI tools to understand?
Accessibility	Are contrast, headings, forms, links, and keyboard navigation usable?
Conversion	Is the call to action visible, low-friction, and supported by trust signals?
Measurement	Do you track visits, conversions, form submissions, and lead quality?
Maintenance	Is there a plan for updates, backups, monitoring, and content improvements?

Quick action plan

Today

Rewrite the homepage headline so it clearly states what you offer, who it is for, and what action to take.

This week

Test the website on mobile, compress large images, and remove obvious friction from the contact path.

This month

Create or improve service pages, FAQs, testimonials, privacy/legal pages, analytics, and accessibility basics.

Next quarter

Review search visibility, AI discoverability, conversion data, and the highest-value pages for improvement.

Want Websiteli to review your website?

Get a practical website review focused on clarity, trust, speed, SEO, accessibility, and conversion. Visit websiteli.ch and request a website audit.

References

Sources were selected from primary or widely used industry research where possible. Always verify key figures before using them in legal, financial, or investment decisions.

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Disclaimer

This report is for general marketing and website strategy purposes. Statistics can change over time, and exact performance outcomes depend on offer quality, traffic source, market, budget, and execution.